QUALITY COUNCIL® OF INDIA
Creating an Ecosystem for Quality

DRDO

System for Advanced Maturity Assessment and Rating
सिस्टम फॉर एडवांस्ड मैच्योरिटी असेसमेंट एंड रेटिंग
SAMAR
Strengthening Defence Ecosystem

Assessor Handbook

Foreword

This handbook is the official operating guide for assessors empanelled under SAMAR, the System for Advanced Maturity Assessment and Rating. SAMAR is administered jointly by the Quality Council of India (QCI) and the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), Ministry of Defence.

It sets out, step by step, how an assessor conducts a site assessment through the SAMAR web portal and the offline mobile application, from allotment of the visit to submission for quality check. The handbook is published for the reference of assessors and other authorised users, and may be circulated freely for that purpose.

For any assistance, contact the SAMAR Operations team through the channels listed in Appendix C.

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Part 1: General Information

Applicable to all users, irrespective of role

1.1 About SAMAR

System for Advanced Maturity Assessment and Rating (SAMAR) is a benchmark to measure the maturity of defence manufacturing and service enterprises. Developed by the Quality Council of India (QCI), the certification is applicable to start-up, micro, small, medium, and large enterprises.

SAMAR is an outcome of the collaboration between Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Quality Council of India (QCI) to strengthen the defence ecosystem in the country with an objective to further the vision of making India self-reliant in defence manufacturing and services.

SAMAR is accessed through a web portal on a desktop or laptop computer. Assessors are additionally provided a mobile application, which is designed to function without an internet connection at the assessment site.

1.2 The eight user roles

The screens and functions available to a user are determined by the role assigned to that user. Eight roles are provided. The assessor is one of them, and the table below indicates the office with which the assessor deals at each stage.

Role	Designation	Scope of visibility
System Admin	Technical custodian of the SAMAR system at QCI/DRDO	Complete access, including system settings and maintenance mode
DRDO Admin	DRDO officer responsible for approving applications	All applications, framework authoring and certificate approval
DRDO Lab	DRDO laboratory referring to the certified vendor register	Read-only access to certified units and the organisation register
Operations Manager	QCI officer responsible for allocation, scheduling and quality check	Records within the States assigned to the officer
Operations Admin	QCI officer responsible for the rating committee and certification	Committee proceedings, ratings and certification
Assessor	Empanelled expert who conducts the on-site assessment	Only the assessments allotted to the assessor
Enterprise Admin	Principal account of the applicant organisation	The organisation and all of its units
Unit Admin	Officer-in-charge of a single unit or site	Only the unit(s) assigned to the officer

> The role assigned to a user is displayed alongside the user's name at the top-right of every screen. In the event of an incorrect role assignment, the SAMAR Operations team is to be intimated. A second account must not be created.

1.3 Authorisation matrix

The following matrix provides a consolidated statement of the functions permitted to each role. Each column represents a role and each row a function. It is reproduced here so that the reader may ascertain which office is to be approached in respect of any given matter.

Function	SA	DRDO Admin	DRDO Lab	Ops Mgr	Ops Admin	Asr	Ent Admin	Unit Admin
Register organisation and units	-	-	-	-	-	-	Y	-
Create and submit an application	-	-	-	-	-	-	Y	Y
Remit the assessment fee	-	-	-	-	-	-	Y	-
Approve or reject an application	-	Y	-	-	-	-	-	-
Allocate assessors and fix the date	-	-	-	Y	-	-	-	-
Conduct the on-site assessment	-	-	-	-	-	Y	-	-
Quality-check a submitted assessment	-	-	-	Y	Y	-	-	-
Conduct the rating committee meeting	-	-	-	-	Y	-	-	-
Record the rating and certify	-	-	-	-	Y	-	-	-
View certified units	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	◐	◐
Administer user accounts	Y	-	-	-	-	-	◐	-
Author parameters and questions	Y	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Configure the fee structure	Y	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Enable or disable maintenance mode	Y	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Y = permitted · ◐ = permitted, restricted to the user's own scope (own organisation, own unit, assigned States, or assessor records only) · : = not permitted

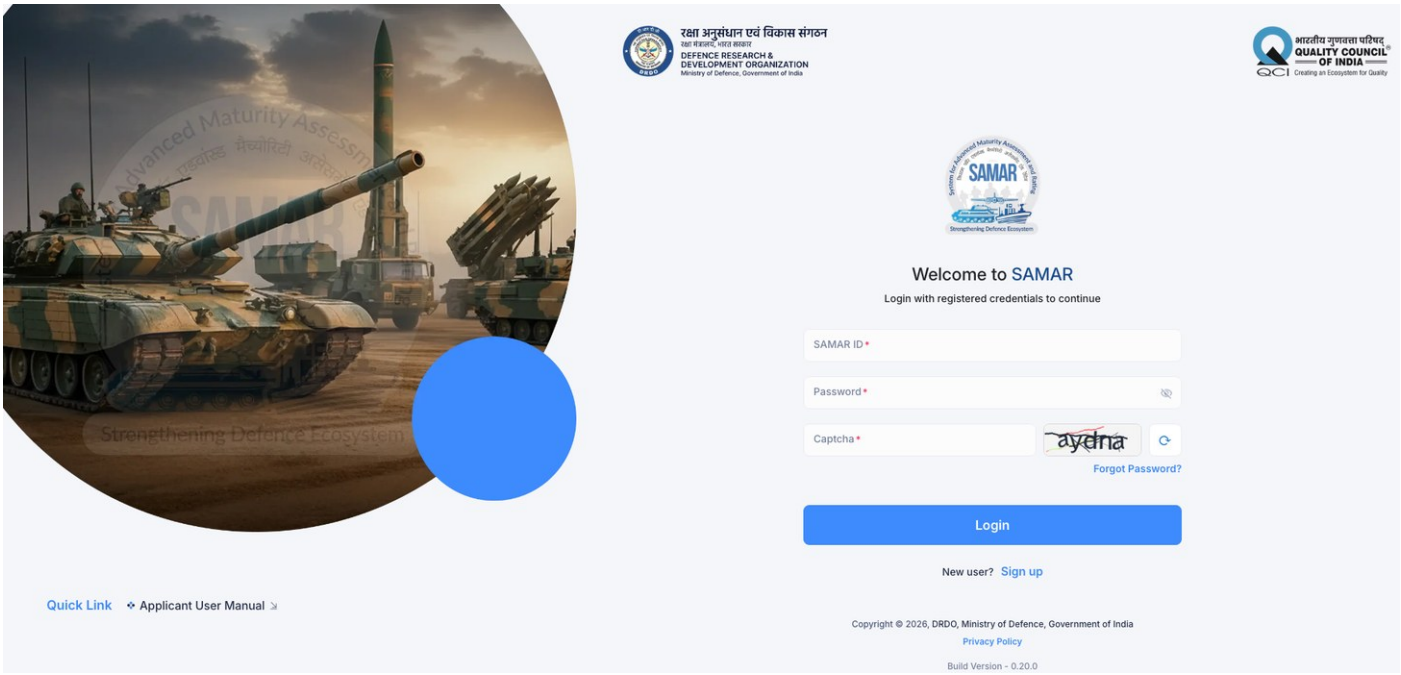
1.4 Logging in

1. Open the SAMAR portal in a web browser.
2. Enter the SAMAR ID together with the password.

   Validation: Both fields are mandatory. Passwords are case-sensitive.
3. Enter the characters shown in the captcha image. Select the refresh icon beside it for a new image.

   Validation: The captcha is not case-sensitive and is valid for five minutes. After an unsuccessful attempt a new image is shown and is to be entered afresh.
4. Select Login.
5. If prompted, enter the six-digit one-time password (OTP) sent to the registered email address and proceed.

   Validation: The OTP is valid for a limited period. Select Resend if it has lapsed.



The login screen accepts the following, and validates them as shown.

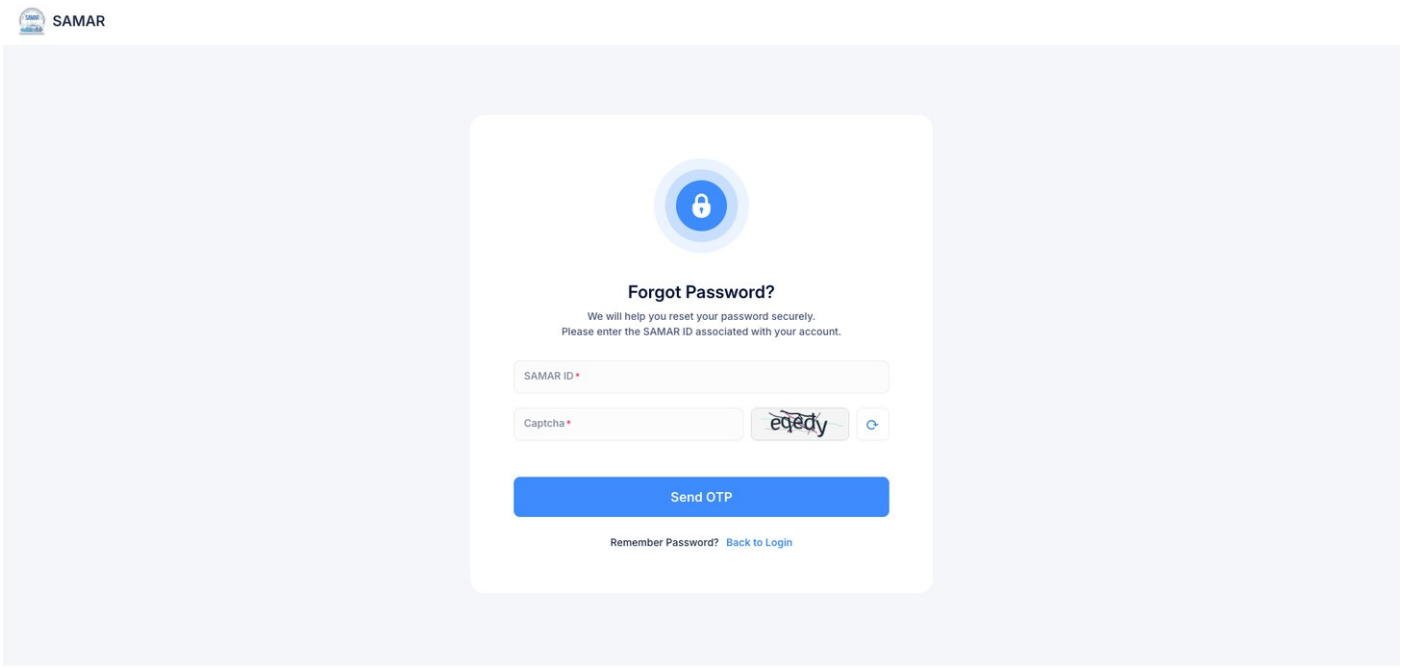
Field	Requirement
SAMAR ID	Required. This is the login identifier issued to the user (not the email address). Format: SAMAR-DDMMYY-N, for example SAMAR-080125-123.
Password	Required. 7 to 20 characters. Case-sensitive.
Captcha	Required on the web portal. The five characters shown in the image; not case-sensitive. The mobile application does not ask for it.

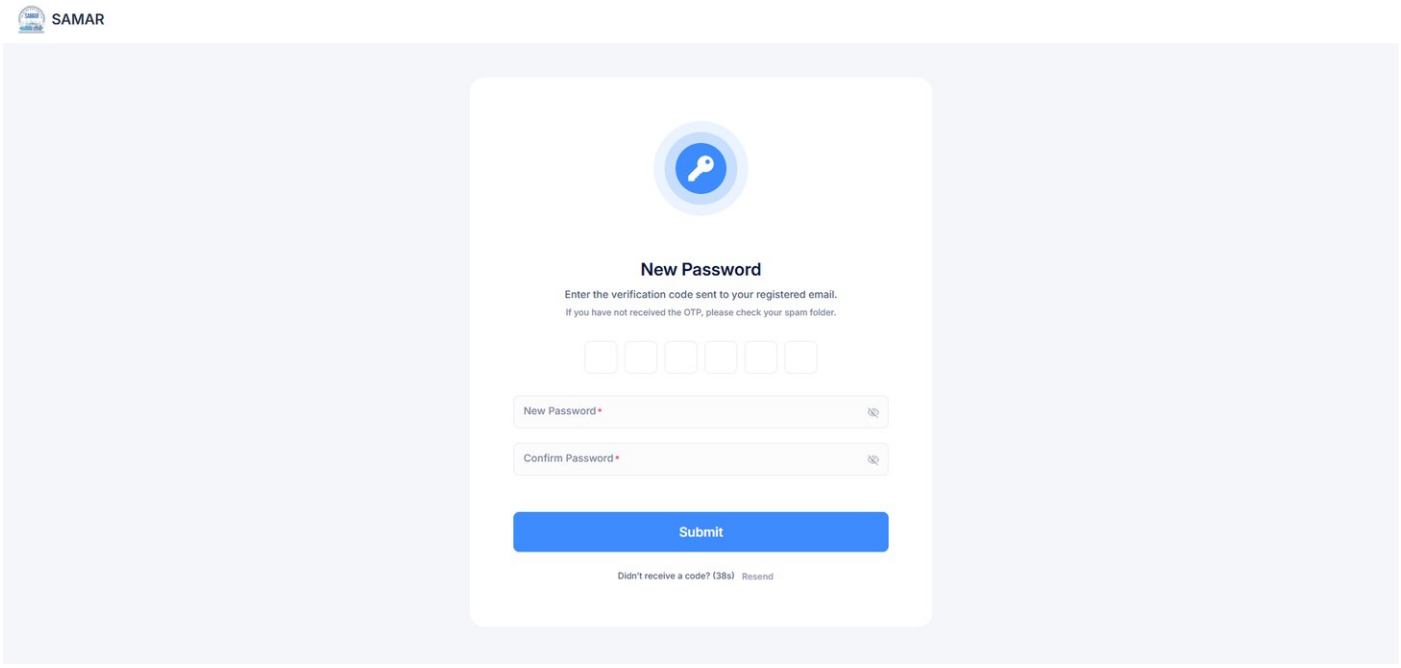
During login you may encounter the following messages.

Situation	Message shown on screen
A new OTP is requested	"A new OTP has been sent to your registered email."
Repeated unsuccessful login attempts	"Too many login attempts. Please wait a few minutes and try again." Login is paused briefly before it may be tried again.
Login could not be completed	"Unable to log in. Please try again or contact support."

1.5 Password reset

1. On the login screen, select Forgot Password.
2. Enter your SAMAR ID and the captcha characters, and select Send OTP. A six-digit OTP is sent to your registered email address.
3. Enter and confirm a new password, and log in again.





The password-reset screens accept the following.

Field	Requirement
SAMAR ID	Required. Format: SAMAR-DDMMYY-N (for example SAMAR-080125-123).
Captcha	Required. The five characters shown in the image; not case-sensitive.
OTP	Required. 6 digits, numbers only. Sent to the registered email address; valid for a limited period and may be resent after 120 seconds.
New Password	Required. 7 to 20 characters.
Confirm Password	Required. Must match the new password.

1.6 Single active session

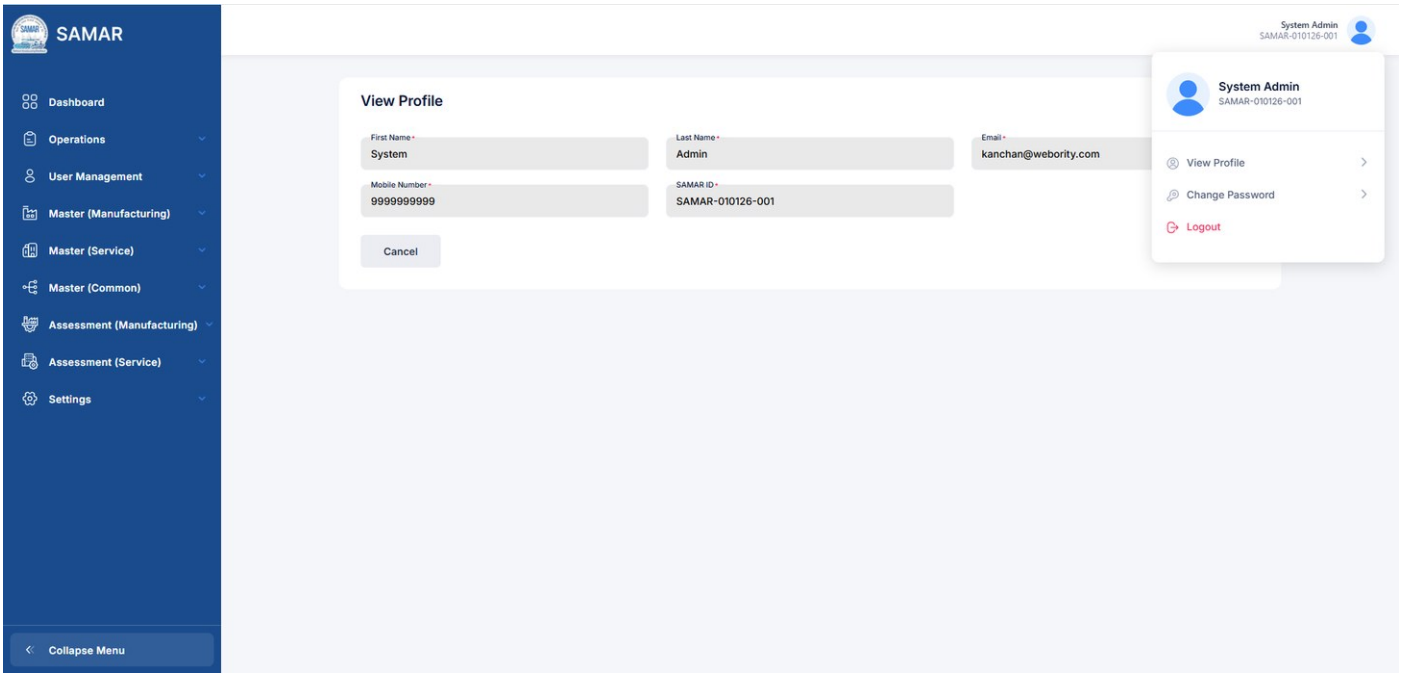
For reasons of security, each user account is restricted to one active session per platform: the web portal and the mobile application are counted separately. Logging in again on the same platform terminates the previous session on it; a web session and a mobile session may be held at the same time. If a user is notified of a login that was not initiated by them, the user should log in again and change the password immediately. Should the occurrence be repeated, the matter is to be reported to the SAMAR Operations team.

1.7 The profile menu

Select the user name displayed at the top-right of any screen. The following options are available to every role:

- View Profile: displays the user's registered particulars.
- Change Password: permits a new password to be set while logged in.
- Logout: terminates the session. Confirmation is sought before the session is closed.

Assessors are provided one additional option, Set Unavailability, which is detailed in paragraph 2.3.



1.8 Assistance and support

The assessor is not provided a Support option in the left menu; that facility is reserved for the applicant roles. Any difficulty encountered, whether in the web portal or in the mobile application, is to be reported to the SAMAR Operations team. The SAMAR ID and the assessment or application number are to be quoted in all correspondence. A matter concerning the date of an assessment or the composition of the assessor team is to be taken up with the Operations Manager.

> Should a maintenance notice be displayed, the system is temporarily unavailable on account of planned maintenance. Users are requested to attempt access subsequently. No saved data is lost during maintenance.

Part 2: The Assessor

Web portal and the offline mobile application

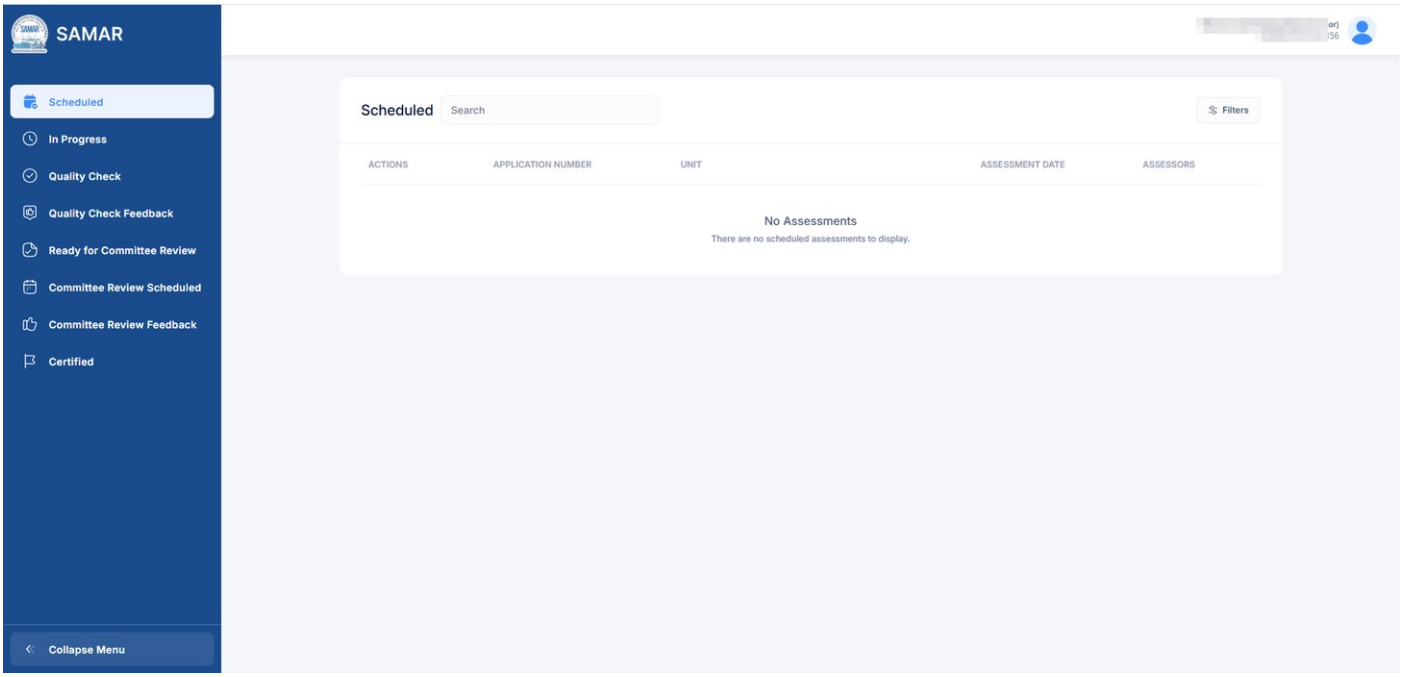
2.1 Scope of the role

Intended user	The empanelled expert who conducts the on-site assessment, using both the web portal and the SAMAR assessor mobile application.
Functions permitted	• View only the assessments allotted to the assessor • Record dates on which the assessor is not available for deputation • Conduct the assessment at the site, offline, through the mobile application • Submit the assessment for quality check (lead assessor only) • Respond to quality-check and rating committee observations
Functions not permitted	• View assessments to which the assessor is not deputed • Select assignments or alter the assessment date • View applicant payment records or fee particulars

2.2 Menu structure

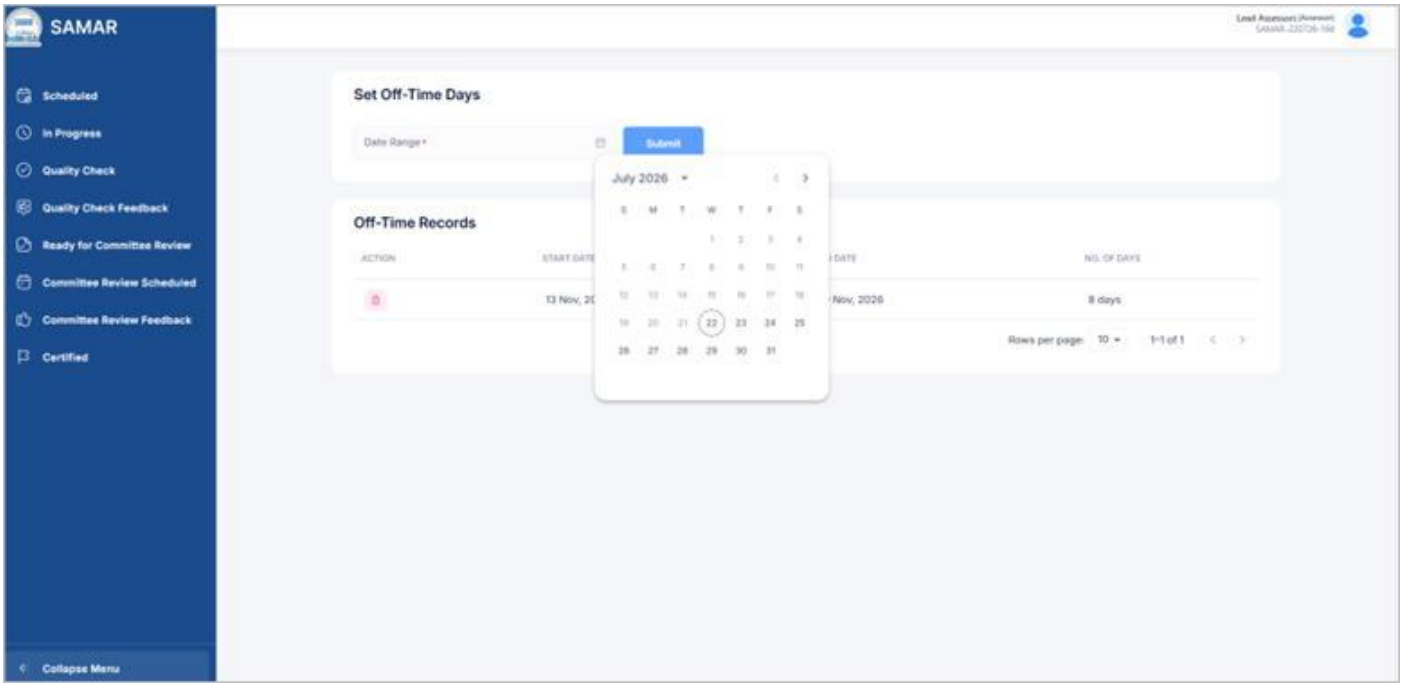
The left menu corresponds to the assessment stages, in sequence. On successful login, the Scheduled screen is displayed. A dashboard is not provided to this role.

Menu	Purpose
Scheduled	Assessments allotted to the assessor for which a date has been confirmed.
In Progress	Assessments presently being recorded by the assessor.
Quality Check	Assessments submitted and under review by the Operations Manager.
Quality Check Feedback	Assessments returned with observations for rectification and resubmission.
Ready for Committee Review	Assessments awaiting consideration by the rating committee.
Committee Review Scheduled	Assessments listed for a committee meeting.
Committee Review Feedback	Assessments on which the committee has sought clarification.
Certified	Assessments completed and certified.



2.3 Set Unavailability

Select the user name at the top-right and choose Set Unavailability in order to record the dates on which deputation is not possible. This record is referred to by the Operations Manager prior to allotment and is therefore to be kept current.



2.4 The mobile application: installation and login

1. Install the SAMAR assessor application on the mobile device.
2. Grant the camera and location permissions. These are required in order to capture site photographs and to record the location at which they were taken.
3. Log in using the SAMAR ID and password, and the six-digit email OTP if prompted. Access to this application is restricted to assessors.

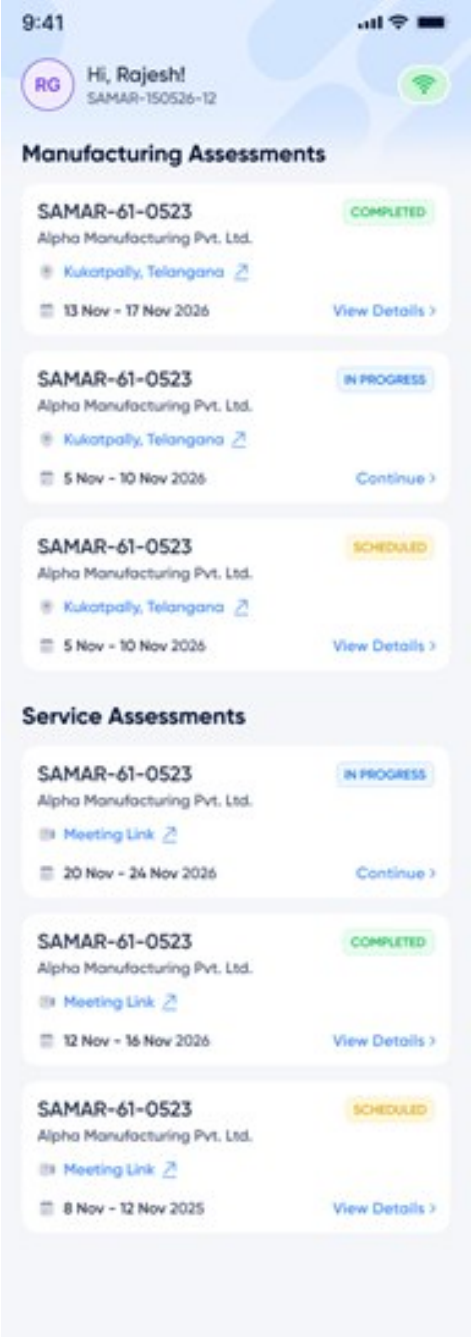
> Logging in to the mobile application on a device terminates any existing session of the application on another device. The web portal session is maintained separately.



2.5 Downloading an assessment

The home screen is organised into two sections by scheme: Manufacturing and Service. Each section lists your assessments as cards; there are no tabs. Each card carries a status badge: Scheduled, In Progress, Completed or Completed on Mobile. Completed assessments are not shown on the home screen.

1. Open the assessment allotted to the assessor.
2. While an internet connection is available, permit the assessment to download in full.
3. Verify that the assessment is listed under In Progress before proceeding to the site, as an internet connection may not be available at many locations.

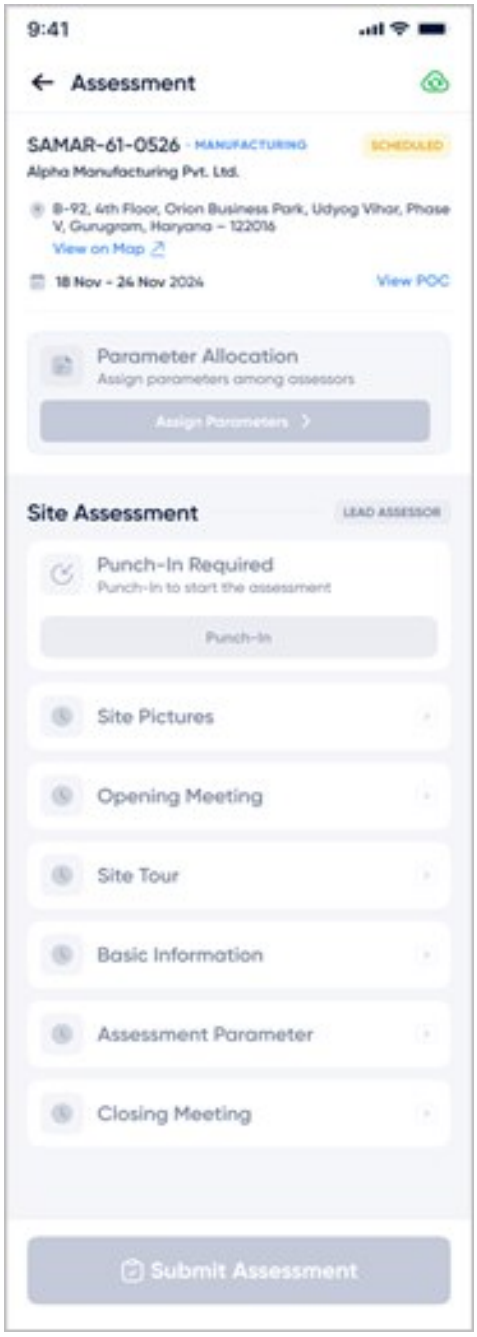


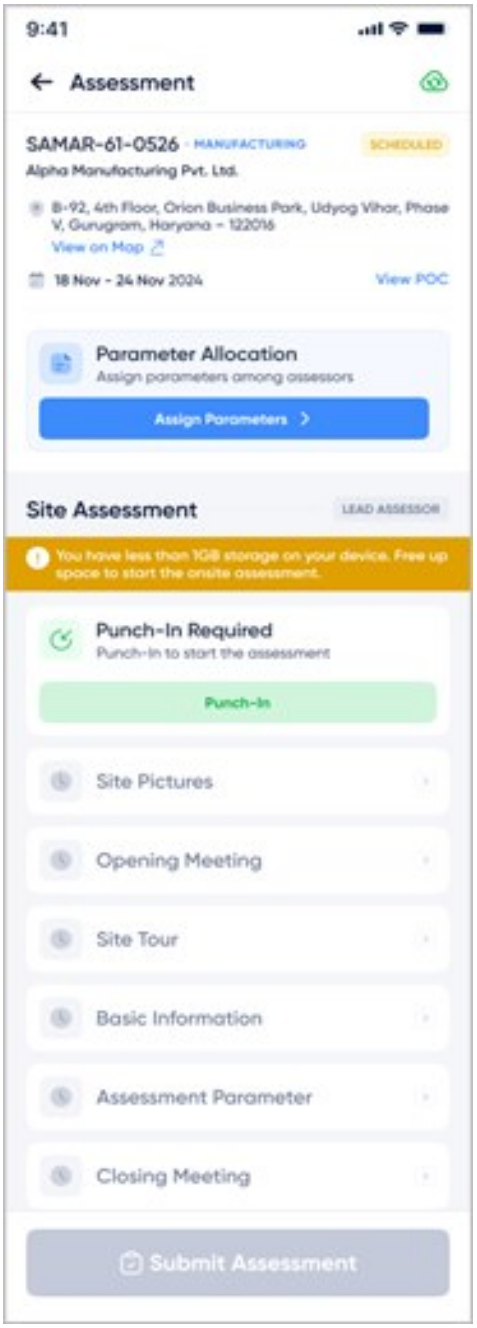
2.6 The on-site steps

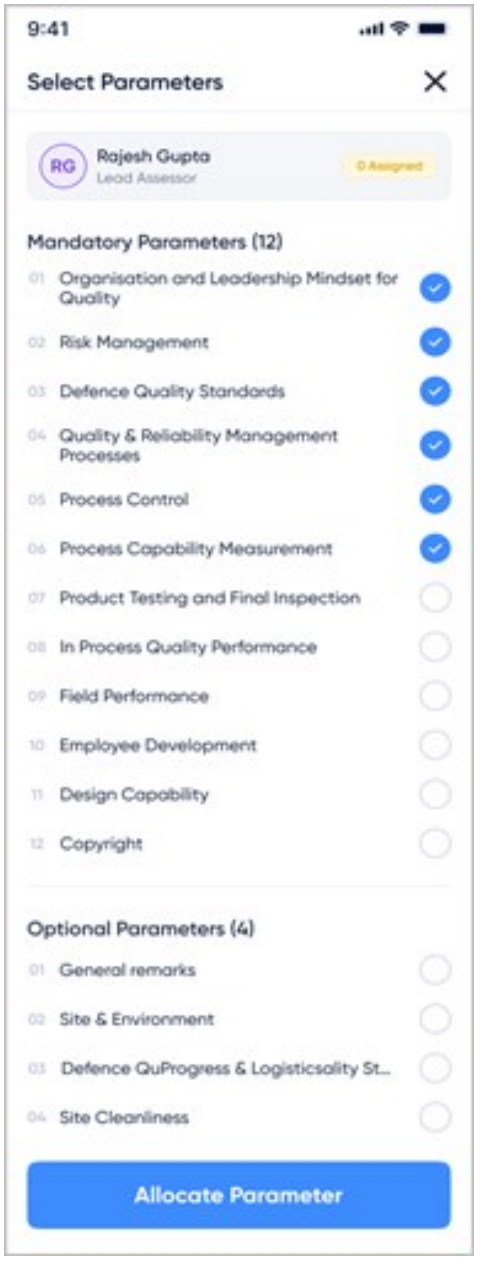
The on-site steps depend on your role. A lead assessor completes all of the steps set out below. A co-assessor completes only Site Pictures, the Site Tour and the Assessment Parameters apportioned to them, in addition to Punch In and Punch Out. Entries may be amended until you tap Complete on Mobile: the final cut-over that follows Punch Out.

#	Step	Action to be taken
1	Punch In	Capture a selfie and record your GPS location (both are required) to mark arrival at the site.

#	Step	Action to be taken
2	Parameter Allocation	Lead assessor only, online: apportion the assessment parameters between the lead assessor and the co-assessors.
3	Site Pictures	Capture the specific site photographs called for in respect of this assessment.
4	Opening Meeting	Record the opening meeting with a photograph, the list of participants and any observations.
5	Site Tour	Capture the site-tour photographs. The date, time and location are recorded against each photograph.
6	Basic Information	Record the unit's products, raw materials, bought-out parts, customers, key resources and processes.
7	Assessment Parameters	Record the responses to the questions under each apportioned parameter and attach the supporting evidence. A photograph captured during the site tour may be selected.
8	Closing Meeting	Record the closing meeting, the participants and any observations.
9	Punch Out	Conclude the on-site session. Punch Out becomes available only after the Closing Meeting and all of your steps are complete.

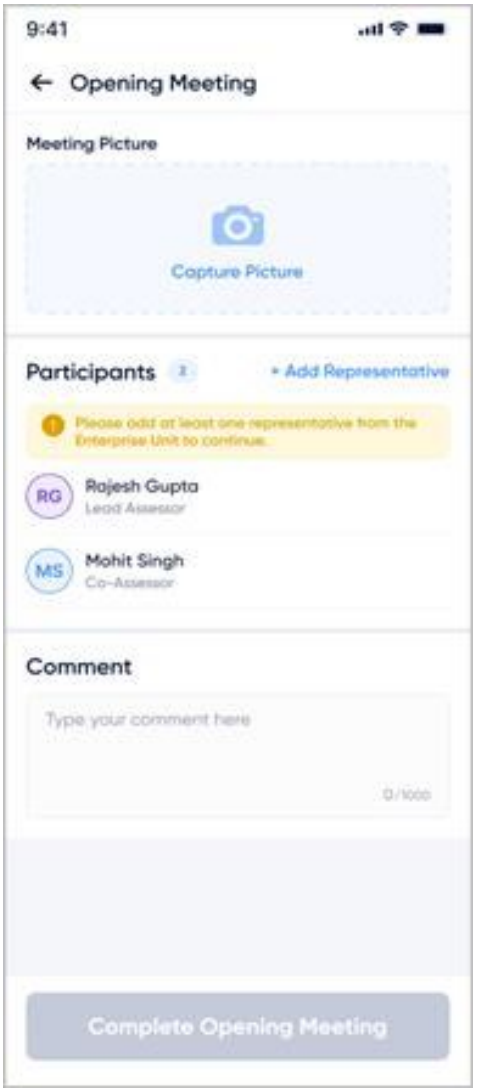

9:41
Assessment
SAMAR-61-0526 · MANUFACTURING
SCHEDULED
Alpha Manufacturing Pvt. Ltd.
B-92, 4th Floor, Orion Business Park, Udyog Vihar, Phase V, Gurugram, Haryana – 122016
View on Map
18 Nov - 24 Nov 2024
View POC
Parameter Allocation
Assign parameters among assessors
Assign Parameters
Site Assessment
LEAD ASSESSOR
Punch-In Required
Punch-In to start the assessment
Punch-In
Site Pictures
Opening Meeting
Site Tour
Basic Information
Assessment Parameter
Closing Meeting
Submit Assessment


9:41
Assessment
SAMAR-61-0526 · MANUFACTURING
SCHEDULED
Alpha Manufacturing Pvt. Ltd.
B-92, 4th Floor, Orion Business Park, Udyog Vihar, Phase V, Gurugram, Haryana – 122016
View on Map
18 Nov - 24 Nov 2024
View POC
Parameter Allocation
Assign parameters among assessors
Assign Parameters
Site Assessment
LEAD ASSESSOR
You have less than 1GB storage on your device. Free up space to start the onsite assessment.
Punch-In Required
Punch-In to start the assessment
Punch-In
Site Pictures
Opening Meeting
Site Tour
Basic Information
Assessment Parameter
Closing Meeting
Submit Assessment

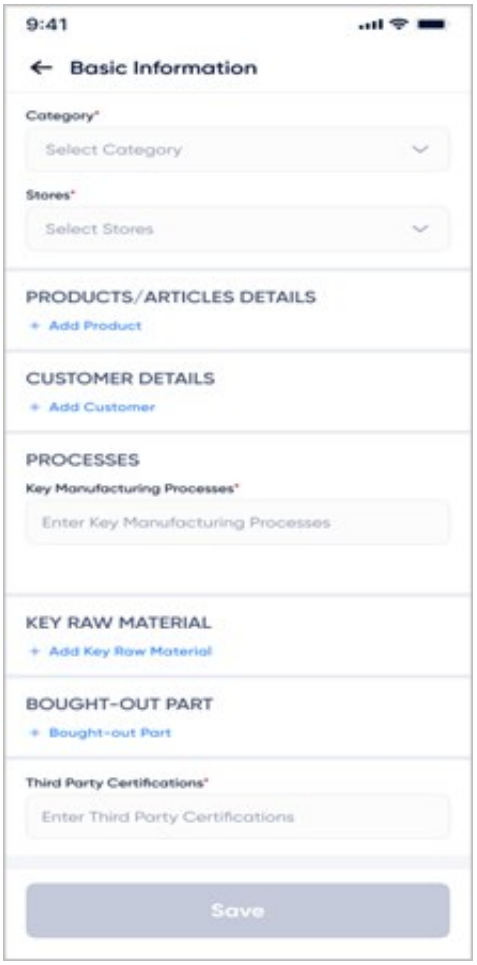

9:41
Select Parameters
RG
Rajesh Gupta
Lead Assessor
0 Assigned
Mandatory Parameters (12)
01 Organisation and Leadership Mindset for Quality
02 Risk Management
03 Defence Quality Standards
04 Quality & Reliability Management Processes
05 Process Control
06 Process Capability Measurement
07 Product Testing and Final Inspection
08 In Process Quality Performance
09 Field Performance
10 Employee Development
11 Design Capability
12 Copyright
Optional Parameters (4)
01 General remarks
02 Site & Environment
03 Defence QuProgress & Logisticsality St...
04 Site Cleanliness
Allocate Parameter

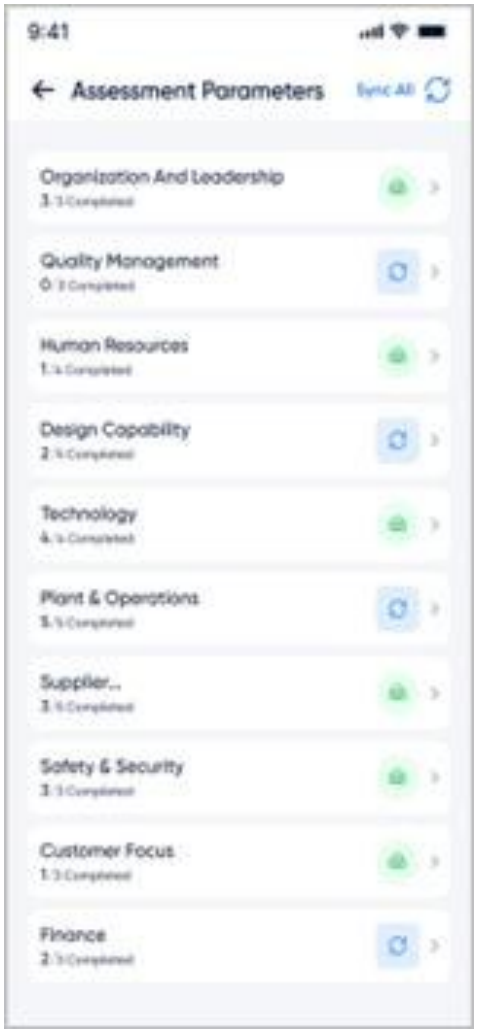

9:41
Punch-In
5 Nov 2024, 09 : 20 AM
28.6289869, 77.2390198
Punch-In

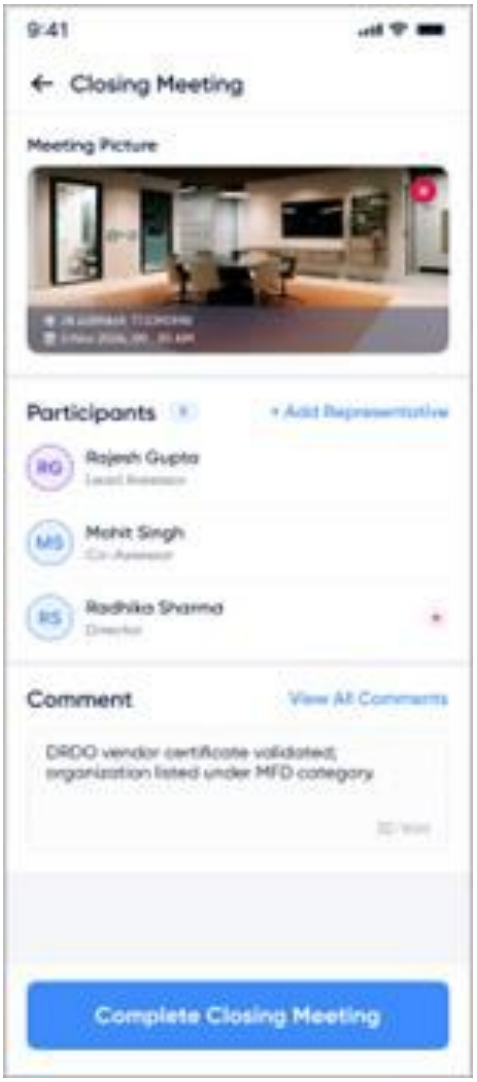

9:41
Site Pictures
Site Exterior Picture
Site Interior Picture
Save


9:41
Opening Meeting
Meeting Picture
Capture Picture
Participants
+ Add Representative
Rajesh Gupta
Lead Assessor
Mohit Singh
Co-Assessor
Comment
Type your comment here
Complete Opening Meeting


9:41
Site Tour
Site Tour Photos 2 / 25
+ Add Image
Safety Line
CNC Machine
Save


9:41
Basic Information
Category*
Select Category
Stores*
Select Stores
PRODUCTS/ARTICLES DETAILS
+ Add Product
CUSTOMER DETAILS
+ Add Customer
PROCESSES
Key Manufacturing Processes*
Enter Key Manufacturing Processes
KEY RAW MATERIAL
+ Add Key Raw Material
BOUGHT-OUT PART
+ Bought-out Part
Third Party Certifications*
Enter Third Party Certifications
Save


9:41
Assessment Parameters
Sync All
Organization And Leadership
Quality Management
Human Resources
Design Capability
Technology
Plant & Operations
Supplier...
Safety & Security
Customer Focus
Finance


9:41
Closing Meeting
Meeting Picture
Participants
+ Add Representative
Rajesh Gupta
Mohit Singh
Radhika Sharma
Comment
View All Comments
DRDO vendor certificate validated, organization listed under MFD category
Complete Closing Meeting



Apportionment of parameters may be carried out only by the lead assessor. Co-assessors are able to view and respond to the parameters apportioned to them.

2.7 Synchronising recorded data

Important: Responses recorded through the mobile application are stored on the device until they are synchronised. Synchronisation is to be carried out whenever an internet connection is available, and no items are to remain unsynced before logging out, as logging out clears the data held on the device.

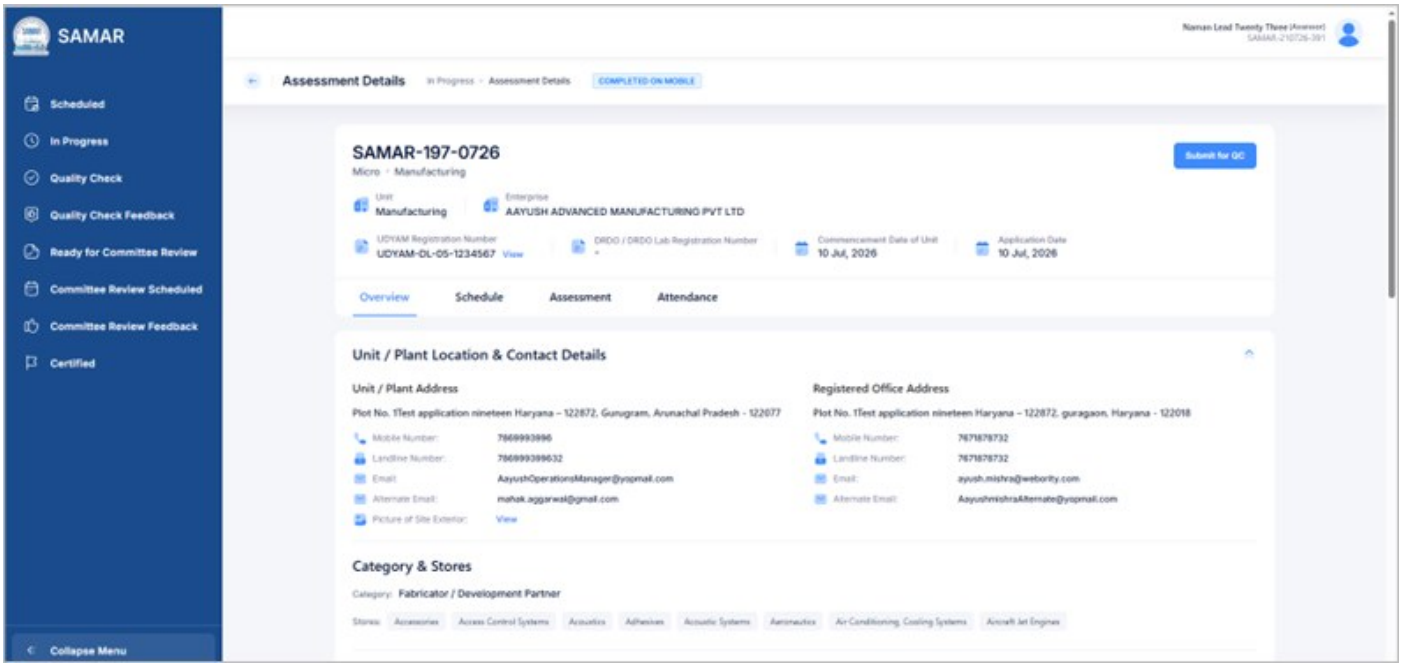
In the event of a synchronisation failure, a list of the items that could not be synchronised is displayed, with a Retry all option. The assessor is to remain logged in, obtain a better connection and attempt synchronisation again. The application must not be uninstalled while items remain pending.

2.8 Submission for quality check

1. On the mobile application, each team member taps Complete on Mobile to finalise the data captured on their device.

2. On the web portal, each co-assessor then submits their apportioned portion. Once all co-assessors have submitted and every member has completed on mobile, the lead assessor submits the assessment for quality check from the web portal.

The assessment is thereafter listed under Quality Check and is taken up for review by the Operations Manager.



2.9 Responding to quality-check observations

Where an assessment is returned by the Operations Manager, it is listed under Quality Check Feedback together with the observations recorded. The observations are to be complied with and the assessment resubmitted.

2.10 Responding to committee observations

Where the rating committee seeks clarification, the assessment is listed under Committee Review Feedback. The clarification is to be furnished against the specific question, with supporting files attached where necessary.

2.11 Deleting locally stored data

On the mobile application, the data stored on the device for an assessment may be deleted (Delete Data), which removes the local copy from that device only. This does not reset the assessment on the server; it can be downloaded again while a connection is available. There is no facility to reset or restart a submitted assessment.

Part 3: Points to be observed

Matters that most commonly give rise to difficulty at the site

3.1 Matters commonly giving rise to difficulty

The following are set out together for ready reference. They apply to every assessor, whether deputed as the lead assessor or as a co-assessor.

Matter	Requirement
Before departure for the site	The assessment is to be downloaded in full while a connection is available, and verified as listed under In Progress.
Permissions	Camera and location permissions are to be granted, failing which photographs cannot be captured or located.
Sequence of steps	The on-site steps, which depend on the assessor's role, are to be completed in order. Entries may be amended until Complete on Mobile is tapped.
Apportionment	Only the lead assessor may apportion parameters. Co-assessors respond only to the portion apportioned to them.
Evidence	Every response is to carry the supporting evidence. A photograph captured during the site tour may be selected.
Before logging out	No items are to remain unsynced. Logging out clears the data held on the device.
Final submission	Only the lead assessor submits, and only after all co-assessors have submitted their portions.
Change of date or team	Neither may be altered by the assessor. The Operations Manager is to be approached.

Appendix A: Application and assessment stages

Every application and assessment proceeds through the stages set out below. The nomenclature is uniform across all roles.

Stage displayed	Meaning	Action rests with
Draft	Under preparation; not yet submitted.	Enterprise / Unit Admin
Approval pending	Submitted and awaiting the decision of DRDO.	DRDO Admin
Payment pending	Approved and awaiting remittance of the fee.	Enterprise / Unit Admin
Payment completed	Fee received; the assessment record has been created.	Operations Manager
Allocation pending	Awaiting allotment of an assessor team and a date.	Operations Manager
Scheduled	Assessor team and date confirmed.	Assessor
In progress	The assessment is being conducted.	Assessor
Quality check	Submitted and under review by QCI.	Operations Manager
Quality check feedback	Returned to the assessor with observations.	Assessor
Ready for committee review	Cleared quality check; awaiting the rating committee.	Operations Admin
Committee review scheduled	Listed for a committee meeting.	Operations Admin
Committee review feedback	Clarification sought by the committee.	Assessor
Certified	Successfully concluded; the certificate has been issued.	-
Rejected	Not proceeded with. The reasons may be ascertained from the SAMAR Operations team.	-

Appendix B: Glossary of terms

Term	Meaning
SAMAR	The certification scheme and the online system supporting it.
SAMAR ID	The unique reference number of a user, to be quoted in all correspondence.
Enterprise	The organisation applying for certification.
Unit	A single site or factory of the organisation. Each unit is certified separately.
Application	A request for the certification of one unit.
Assessment	The on-site examination conducted by an assessor against the application.
Allocation	The allotment of an assessor team and a date to an assessment.
Lead assessor	The assessor who apportions the parameters and makes the final submission.
Co-assessor	An assessor who responds to the parameters apportioned to them.
Parameter	An area against which the unit is assessed, comprising a set of questions.
Evidence	A photograph or file attached in support of a response.
Quality check (QC)	The review by QCI of a submitted assessment prior to its placement before the committee.
Rating committee (RC)	The panel that reviews the assessment and determines the rating.
Certification	The recording of the committee's decision, upon which the certificate is issued.
Renewal	A fresh application made prior to the expiry of a certificate, from a pre-filled copy.
OTP	A six-digit one-time password despatched by email for verification of identity.
Synchronisation	The transmission of data recorded on a mobile device to the SAMAR system.
Maintenance mode	A planned period during which access is restricted to the System Admin.

Appendix C: Points of contact

Matter	To be referred to
Correction of an incorrect role, or a login that cannot be recovered	SAMAR Operations team
Change of an assessment date, or of the composition of the assessor team	Operations Manager
An allotment that is not visible in the portal or in the mobile application	Operations Manager
Observations recorded at quality check	Operations Manager
Clarification sought by the rating committee	Operations Admin, through the SAMAR Operations team
Failure of synchronisation, or a fault in the mobile application	SAMAR Operations team, quoting the assessment number. The application must not be uninstalled while items remain pending.

The SAMAR ID and the assessment or application number are to be quoted in every communication, as this enables the earliest resolution.